ALIREZA ESFANDIARI

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Business Analyst | AI & Automation Delivery, AI Agents & RAG, Requirements & UAT, SQL & Python

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Business analyst with **4+ years** in telecom, banking, health tech, and retail, now on a telecom B2B AI team taking AI and automation from discovery to adoption, with an **MSc** (Business Analytics minor) and an **MBA**.
- On the business side: requirements and BRDs, process discovery, acceptance criteria, user acceptance testing (UAT), and adoption, including a **$408K** business case taken to senior leadership sign-off.
- On the technical side: SQL and Python, an ETL pipeline into BigQuery, and AI I build myself: agents with tool calling and RAG on IBM watsonx and the Claude SDK, evaluation sets, and machine learning models.
- Co-founded a health-tech startup, raised two funding rounds, and led its pivot to an app for doctors that grew to **10,000+** users; CSPO and SAFe POPM certified.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Business Analyst, Process Intelligence (B2B AI)
January 2026 - Present

TELUS | *Remote, Canada*

- Wrote the business requirements document (BRD) for an LLM-based contract review in a post-acquisition migration of about **60K accounts and 12K contracts**, turning privacy and data-residency rules from Legal and the Data Trust Office into acceptance criteria.
- Took it from proof of concept to production: tested model outputs with business and Legal reviewers across **6** language releases and fed each round of errors back to the AI engineers until the release went live.
- Handed it over as a self-serve tool; found that another team had used about **7,000 of 8,500** AI outputs without reporting the benefit, built the business case, and drove **$408K** to senior leadership sign-off; part of the team that delivered about **$2.5M** in benefits.
- Shaping an agentic AI use case for billing adjustment requests (more than **80%** arrive incomplete): mapped the current state with subject matter experts, scoped the first release to the **top 5** request types from 2025 data, and wrote the future-state process design document: a sales chatbot connected to billing and contract systems, and an AI review queue where people decide.
- Ran process discovery sessions on how order data flows from opportunity to billing, mapped data across **10** systems including Salesforce (owning extraction for **4** legacy systems), and found the identifier that stitched records end to end, showing where about **20%** of closed-won orders in one product line stalled; my request led another team to build a new identifier.
- Built a nightly ETL pipeline (SQL, Python, YAML) from Oracle into BigQuery, deployed through a GitHub workflow with automated CI checks, and wrote Python and Selenium automation that replaced about **30,000** hours of manual data pulls and contract transfers.
- Built a multi-agent workflow on n8n (Claude via an enterprise gateway) that turns meeting transcripts into validated JSON, project charters, and tracked tasks, with deterministic triggers and API and OAuth integrations to Google Workspace, monday.com, and Redis; later migrated it to Claude Projects and Skills.
- Run weekly stand-up-style sessions with developers, AI engineers, and subject matter experts, write charters and weekly leadership updates, and track risks and dependencies across concurrent initiatives.

Business Analyst
April 2020 - September 2021

Baadraan Universal Trading | *Tehran, Iran*

- Gathered functional and system requirements for a new inventory system at a retailer with **80,000+ active users**, and worked with developers and QA analysts to turn them into solution design and UAT criteria.
- Helped prioritize backlog features such as real-time inventory tracking and advanced search filters, which led to a **15%** increase in sales and **20%** fewer stockouts.
- Automated stock alerts for best-selling products: a SQL trigger writes to an alert table when stock hits the safety level, a cron job queries it, and Zabbix provides real-time monitoring.

Co-Founder **March 2019 - March 2020**

CloudMed | *Tehran, Iran*

- Spotted that the first imaging product wasn't generating revenue, ran a customer-centric market analysis, then proposed and led the pivot to an educational social media app for doctors and built its foundation; the app went on to reach **10,000+ users** and about **$100K CAD** in annual revenue.
- Ran discovery and user interviews with imaging centers, doctors, patients, and administrators, and turned their needs and Ministry of Health privacy rules into epics and user stories with acceptance criteria.
- Ran product demos at imaging centers that increased client acquisition by **40%**, and raised about **$200K+** in each of two funding rounds: from an angel investor, then through 2nd place in the **100Startups** competition.

Jr. Business Analyst **November 2017 - March 2019**

Ayandeh Bank | *Tehran, Iran*

- Extracted and analyzed transactional data with SQL for reporting on credit card usage, deposits, withdrawals, loan repayments, and customer segments.
- Built Power BI dashboards and Excel reports tracking branch KPIs such as loan disbursement rates, non-performing loan (NPL) ratios, and customer acquisition.
- Helped senior analysts write functional specs and user stories in Jira for modules such as credit scoring, and took part in UAT for core banking updates, validating transaction posting and interest calculations.

PROJECTS

Agentic AI for Billing Adjustments on IBM watsonx, Personal Project **2026**

Python, SQL, IBM watsonx Orchestrate, watsonx.data (Presto, Iceberg), IBM Bob (AI coding assistant), GitHub

- Built a working proof of concept (POC) on synthetic data for a common telecom problem: credit requests for customers who were billed wrong often arrive incomplete, and reviewers check each one by hand.
- Designed two AI agents: one helps sales submit complete requests, and one advises reviewers, who make the final call; both use tool calling to pull customer data with SQL and search company policies with RAG.
- Kept the AI from making up numbers (hallucinations): Python code calculates every credit and checks the approval limits, and every decision is logged for audit; tested with **19** unit tests and **12** test cases, all passing.
- Automated deployment with Python scripts, kept API keys away from the code and the model, limited each agent to the tools its role needs, and switched from IBM Granite to gpt-oss-120b after tracing failed tool calls.

AI Product Finder (RAG), Personal Project **2026**

Python, Claude SDK, ChromaDB, sentence-transformers (BGE embeddings), Flask

- Built an AI product finder that runs locally with a search-style web page: users describe a problem or need, and a Claude SDK agent with tool calling uses retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) over ChromaDB to recommend a product or bundle from a catalog of **628 products**.
- Built a **16-question** evaluation set that scores retrieval and recommendations and compared three Claude models and two prompts; rephrasing needs into catalog terms raised correct picks from **11 to 13 of 14**.
- Started with an annual report Q&A agent: built over raw HTTP first, cites pages, tested with an evaluation suite.

Automated Loan Decisioning, Personal Project **2025**

Business rules, Gherkin, BPMN, SQL

- Wrote a full requirements package for automating personal-loan decisions: business rules, a functional specification, Gherkin user stories, As-Is and To-Be BPMN process flows, a UAT plan, and SQL.

Machine Learning and Statistics Projects, MSc and Personal **2022 - 2024**

Python (pandas, NumPy), scikit-learn, imbalanced-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, Keras Tuner, SAS, SPSS

- Fraud detection (personal, 2024): on about **285K** card transactions with a heavily imbalanced fraud class, used SMOTE and recursive feature elimination, and compared random forest, SVM, logistic regression, and KNN with LSTM, GRU, and DNN networks; the reported model reached **0.97** precision and **0.77** recall (F1 **0.86**).
- Forecasting (MSc, 2023): compared KNN regression with LSTM, bidirectional LSTM, GRU, bidirectional GRU, and 1D CNN models in Keras across **5** time series, evaluated on held-out data with RMSE, MAE, and MAPE.
- Income prediction (MSc, 2022, team of 3): compared **7** classifiers on **32,561** census records, including a deep neural network and an autoencoder, plus a SAS Enterprise Miner version where a decision tree did best.

- Statistics (MSc, 2022): multiple and stepwise regression of insurance premiums with assumption checks (VIF, constant variance), finding age, children, smoking, and BMI significant, and a survey moderation hypothesis tested with Hayes PROCESS in SPSS.

Power BI and Tableau Dashboards, Portfolio Projects

Power BI, Tableau Public, Excel, BigQuery (GCP)

- Built a Power BI star-schema model joining **3** years of sales, product, store, and campaign data, with interactive dashboards on sales, revenue, and cost trends.
- Cleaned government open data in Excel, loaded it into BigQuery, and built Tableau dashboards on regional internet access and download-to-visit conversion.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MSc) in Marketing, Minor in Business Analytics January 2022 - March 2025
Concordia University | *Montreal, Canada*
Data mining, applied statistics, machine learning; Research Assistant (Python, SAS, SPSS)
Relevant coursework: *Foundations of Data Mining, Advanced Data Mining, Applied Statistical Linear Models, Research Methods, Consumer Research Methods, Consumer Psychology, New Product Development and Innovation, Branding*

Master of Business Administration (MBA) September 2017 - December 2019
Amirkabir University of Technology | *Tehran, Iran*
Ranked top 0.5% of 40,000

Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Engineering February 2013 - June 2017
Petroleum University of Technology | *Iran*

SKILLS

- **Business Analysis & Delivery:** Requirements elicitation, process discovery and mapping, BRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, current and future state design, UAT, business cases, adoption and user enablement, Agile/Scrum, SAFe
- **AI & Automation:** AI agents and multi-agent workflows (IBM watsonx Orchestrate, n8n), tool calling, RAG, embeddings, vector databases (ChromaDB), evaluation sets, AI output validation, Claude SDK and API, Selenium
- **Data & Machine Learning:** SQL, Python (pandas, NumPy), ETL, BigQuery (GCP), Oracle, watsonx.data (Presto, Iceberg), MySQL, scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, Power BI, Tableau, Excel, process mining
- **Engineering & Tools:** Git and GitHub, CI/CD (familiar), pytest, Infrastructure-as-Code (YAML), Jira, Confluence, monday.com, Visio

CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

- **Certifications:** SAFe Product Owner/Product Manager (POPM), Scaled Agile; Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), Scrum Alliance; Market Research & Consumer Behavior, Coursera
- **Languages:** English and Persian (fluent), French (intermediate to advanced)